■ THE DAILY GOODS STORY SCOUT - Friday, September 11, 2026

TODAY'S RUNDOWN SLOTS

THE LIST (5 stories)

■ *New York changed in dramatic and surprising ways in the 25 years since 9/11*

The Angle: *It's the 25th anniversary of 9/11, and this piece digs into how dramatically New York itself changed afterward - not just security and skylines, but the mood of the city. It's a big, reflective conversation starter that resonates well beyond New York.*

- Marks **25 years** since **9/11**, with a fresh look at how the attacks reshaped **New York City**
- New Yorkers themselves say the city **"changed forever"** in the aftermath
- Many residents worried the changes were for **the worse**, not the better

The Reflection Starter

- Where were you when you heard the news, and do you think your own city changed after 9/11 too?

torontosun.com (Tier 2) | Score: 82/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 29 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://torontosun.com/news/world/new-york-changed-in-dramatic-and-surprising-ways-in-the-25-years-since-9-11

■ *Florida woman sues over wrongful arrest tied to Flock camera data*

The Angle: *Flock Safety's license-plate cameras are popping up in cities everywhere, and this lawsuit puts a real face on the fear people have about automated surveillance making life-altering mistakes.*

- A **Florida woman** is suing after she says she was wrongfully arrested based on data from a **Flock Safety** license-plate camera.
- **Flock** cameras are used by police departments nationwide to scan and track vehicles.
- The lawsuit puts a spotlight on what happens when automated surveillance tech gets it wrong — and who's on the hook for it.

The Debate Starter

- Should a camera's data ever be enough on its own to arrest someone?

Reddit r/technology (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.foxnews.com/tech/innocent-woman-says-police-use-flock-camera-led-13-days-jail?msockid=302df82831bf6695193aed763014675d

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■ *Former Obama Admin Official Says It's Time To Consider Military Strikes on Chinese Data Centers to Prevent Them From Reaching AGI*

The Angle: *A former Obama administration official is floating military strikes on Chinese data centers to stop China from reaching artificial general intelligence first — a wild escalation in the AI arms race that turns tech policy into a national security flashpoint.*

- A **former Obama administration official** is publicly suggesting the U.S. consider **military strikes** on **Chinese data centers**.
- The stated goal: stop China from reaching **AGI** (artificial general intelligence) before the U.S. does.
- It reframes the AI race with China as a matter of **national security and potential armed conflict**, not just tech competition.

The Debate Starter

- Is bombing data centers to stop an AI race sober strategy or dangerously reckless — where's the line?

Reddit r/technology (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.yahoo.com/news/politics/articles/former-obama-admin-official-says-180208350.html

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■ *Millions Could Spend Half Their Income on Food by 2050, Scientists Warn: New projections suggest that by 2050, millions of the world's poorest people could be spending around half their income on food alone.*

The Angle: *A new scientific projection warns the world's poorest people could be spending half their income just to eat by 2050 - a wake-up call as grocery prices are already a top complaint for listeners right now.*

- New scientific projections point to **2050** as the flashpoint year
- Millions of the world's **poorest people** could be affected
- Food could eat up roughly **half their income**, per the forecast

The Debate Starter

- Grocery prices already have everyone griping - would you believe food costs could eat HALF a paycheck someday?

Reddit r/futurology (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.sciencealert.com/millions-could-spend-half-their-income-on-food-by-2050-scientists-warn

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■■ *Chinese scientists propose converting some of the 12,000 abandoned coal mines across China into agricultural units, to test out new approaches to farming – approaches that might become increasingly important as the climate shifts. Another bonus of farming underground is access to geothermal energy.*

The Angle: *It sounds like sci-fi, but it's a real pitch: repurpose thousands of dead mines into farmland that could survive a shifting climate, powered by free heat from deep underground. It's the kind of wild-but-plausible idea that makes people rethink what farming even looks like in 50 years.*

- Scientists are eyeing roughly **12,000 abandoned coal mines** across **China** for the project.
- The pitch: convert the shafts into **underground agricultural units** to test new farming methods.
- Researchers say it could be a hedge against **climate shifts** making surface farming harder.
- Bonus perk: underground sites tap **geothermal energy** for heating/cooling farms for free.

The Debate Starter

- Would you trust vegetables grown a half-mile underground in an old coal mine?

Reddit r/science (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.sciencealert.com/chinese-scientists-propose-turning-abandoned-coal-mines-into-farming-laboratories

Backup options:

■ *Donald Trump’s ban on Canadian spirits will mean lost jobs — but many will be in the U.S.*

The Angle: *It's a trade war twist made for talk radio: a ban meant to squeeze Canada is set to boomerang and wipe out American jobs in the process — the kind of self-inflicted irony that makes for an easy debate on air.*

- **Donald Trump's** ban targets **Canadian spirits** as part of the ongoing trade dispute
- Reports indicate the fallout will hit jobs on **both sides of the border**
- A notable chunk of the job losses are expected to land in the **U.S.**, not Canada

The Irony Angle

- A tariff aimed at Canada ends up costing American jobs — does that change how you feel about the trade war?

Reddit r/canada (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.thestar.com/business/canada-sends-half-of-its-2-billion-in-spirits-to-the-u-s-but-donald-trump-s-ban-could-cost-americans-their-jobs/article_87c0e9ef-7c2a-4538-8c18-b41090b7fcb5.html

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■ *Saudi airstrikes hit Yemen's rebel-held Mokha airport as Houthis capture strategic island*

The Angle: *This isn't just a regional skirmish — it's a fight over one of the most important shipping lanes on the planet, and it could mean higher gas prices and pricier goods for everyone if oil tankers get squeezed again.*

- **Houthi rebels**, backed by **Iran**, seized a strategic island in the **Bab el-Mandeb Strait** — the narrow gateway to the **Red Sea**
- **Saudi Arabia** responded with airstrikes on the rebel-held **Mokha airport** in **Yemen**
- The strait is one of the world's busiest commercial shipping lanes, and this move directly threatens **Saudi oil exports**
- Officials called it a **"swift advance"** — meaning this escalated fast, not gradually

Why You Should Care

- Every time this waterway gets threatened, it's the reason gas prices spike back home — so this is way bigger than a far-off headline.

www.cbc.ca (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.cbc.ca/news/world/saudi-strikes-yemen-mokha-airport-houthis-island-9.7339979?cmp=rss

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■■ *Sovereignty referendum would cost $130M under a Parti Québécois government, leader says*

The Angle: *Quebec's separatist party is putting a price tag on a referendum most people assumed was just political talk — a real number makes the 2029-2030 sovereignty push suddenly feel a lot more concrete.*

- **Parti Québécois** leader says a sovereignty referendum would cost at least **$130 million**
- The vote would happen if PQ forms government, targeted for **2029 or 2030**
- Price tag covers running the referendum itself, not any fallout from the result

The Debate Starter

- Is $130 million a fair price for democracy, or a wildly expensive way to reopen a fight Canada already settled twice?

www.cbc.ca (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.cbc.ca/news/canada/montreal/sovereignty-pspp-pq-quebec-cost-9.7339986?cmp=rss

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CANADIAN NEWS (3 stories)

■ *Ontario Science Centre laying off entire science department*

The Angle: *It's the kind of headline that sounds fake but isn't - a science museum cutting its entire science department is exactly the brand of irony that gets people talking, especially with the Ontario Science Centre already under fire after its abrupt 2024 closure.*

- The **Ontario Science Centre** is reportedly laying off its **entire science department**
- Story's making the rounds on **r/nottheonion** - the irony is the whole appeal

The Irony Alert

- A science centre with no science staff left - does that even still count as a science centre?

Reddit r/nottheonion (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.cp24.com/politics/queens-park/2026/09/10/ontario-science-centre-laying-off-entire-science-department/

■■ *Zelenskyy says Canada has agreed a big air defence package for Ukraine*

The Angle: *Canada wading deeper into the Ukraine war effort is a real foreign-policy story for a Canadian audience, and it's coming straight from Zelenskyy himself, which gives it extra weight and news value.*

- **Volodymyr Zelenskyy** says **Canada** has agreed to a major air defence package for Ukraine.
- Details on size, cost, and timeline aren't confirmed yet - that's the next thing to watch for.

The Debate Starter

- Should Canada be sending more military hardware overseas, or focusing that money at home?

Reddit r/canada (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.cp24.com/news/canada/2026/09/10/pm-carney-tells-zelenskyy-canada-will-help-ukraine-rebuild/

■ *Poilievre tells U.S. TV Canadians are 'wounded' and 'confused' to be in America's crosshairs*

The Angle: *The Conservative leader took Canada's frustration straight to an American audience, and the word choices - 'wounded,' 'confused' - are the kind of raw, personal language that cuts through the usual trade-dispute noise and taps into a broader mood about the Canada-U.S. relationship.*

- **Pierre Poilievre** made the comments in an interview on **U.S. television**, not a Canadian outlet - a deliberate move to speak straight to an American audience.
- He described Canadians as feeling **"wounded"** and **"confused"** over being caught in **America's crosshairs**.
- The remarks frame Canada as blindsided by hostility from a country it's long considered its closest ally.

The Debate Starter

- Does hearing 'wounded and confused' actually capture how you feel about the U.S. relationship right now, or does it sound like political spin?

Reddit r/canada (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.cbc.ca/news/politics/poilievre-new-york-carney-trump-9.7338906

Backup options:

■ *Mark Carney's support surge coming largely from former Conservatives, poll finds*

The Angle: *A new poll suggests Mark Carney's rising numbers aren't coming from stealing Liberal loyalists back - they're coming from former Conservative voters crossing the aisle, which is a much bigger story about where Canadian politics is actually shifting right now.*

- Poll finds **Mark Carney's** recent support surge is driven largely by voters who previously backed the **Conservative Party**
- Suggests movement of former **Conservative** supporters into **Carney's** camp, rather than growth from his own party's existing base
- Raises questions about whether this is a lasting realignment or a temporary bounce

The Debate Starter

- If you voted Conservative last time but you're eyeing Carney now - what changed your mind?

Reddit r/canada (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://nationalpost.com/opinion/mark-carney-support-former-conservatives-poll

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■ *Carney Calls US Trade Bans 'Modest,' Signals Canada Won't Retaliate*

The Angle: *Canada's PM is choosing restraint over retaliation on US trade bans, calling them "modest" - a notably soft response that's got people asking if Ottawa is playing it too safe.*

- **Mark Carney** described the latest **US trade bans** as "**modest**"
- He's signaling **Canada will not retaliate** against the measures
- The comments mark a notably calmer tone than past Canada-US trade flare-ups

The Debate Starter

- Is Carney being smart and strategic here, or should Canada be hitting back harder?

Reddit r/canada (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.bloomberg.com/news/articles/2026-09-10/carney-calls-us-trade-bans-modest-signals-canada-won-t-retaliate

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■ *This lab is still trying to identify 9/11 victims 25 years later. Not everyone wants to know*

The Angle: *As the 25th anniversary approaches, a forensic lab is still working to match remains to names from Ground Zero — but the twist that'll stop hosts cold is that some families have asked them to stop trying.*

The Debate Starter

- After 25 years, would you want that call — or would you rather let it rest?

www.cbc.ca (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.cbc.ca/news/world/lab-identifying-911-victim-remains-9.7338354?cmp=rss

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ENTERTAINMENT (4 stories)

■ *Kaia Gerber on ‘The Shards’ Finale’s Surprising Killer Suspects and Her Shelley Duvall Moment - The Hollywood Reporter*

The Angle: *Ryan Murphy's twisty Bret Easton Ellis adaptation just dropped its finale and pointed the finger at basically every character — star Kaia Gerber is opening up about the whodunit and her full-on horror-movie moment.*

- **Kaia Gerber** plays queen-bee high schooler **Susan** in Ryan Murphy's take on Bret Easton Ellis' **'The Shards.'**
- The finale, titled **'Stairway to Heaven,'** wraps nine episodes of terror from a serial killer nicknamed **'The Trawler.'**
- Gerber says the ending **points the finger at everyone** — a full cliffhanger on who the killer actually is.
- She describes a **'The Shining'-inspired scream-queen scene**, calling it her own **Shelley Duvall moment**.

The Debate Starter

- Callers: who do YOU think 'The Trawler' really is — and does Gerber actually know, or is she just as in the dark as us?

Hollywood Reporter (via NewsAPI) (Tier 1) | Score: 86/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 29 quality) -> LEAD

URL: http://www.hollywoodreporter.com/tv/tv-news/the-shards-finale-killer-theories-kaia-gerber-interview-1236695954/

■ *Jimmy Kimmel’s Interview With James Talarico Heading to YouTube to Avoid FCC Hassle - The Hollywood Reporter*

The Angle: *Kimmel just got yanked off air once already over FCC pressure this year, so him quietly moving a political sit-down to YouTube instead of ABC is a real 'here we go again' moment for free speech vs. broadcast rules.*

- **Jimmy Kimmel's** Thursday interview with **Texas Senate hopeful James Talarico** won't air on the ABC broadcast of *Jimmy Kimmel Live!*
- It'll stream instead on the show's **YouTube channel**
- Kimmel pointed to ongoing friction between **ABC and the FCC** as the reason for the switch
- Report notes Kimmel is 'mad' about the situation, per **The Hollywood Reporter**

The Debate Starter

- Is this networks quietly caving to government pressure, or just smart producers routing around a headache — and does it matter if it's on YouTube either way?

Hollywood Reporter (via NewsAPI) (Tier 1) | Score: 82/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 25 quality) -> LEAD

URL: http://www.hollywoodreporter.com/tv/tv-news/jimmy-kimmel-james-talarico-interview-fcc-brendan-carr-1236696255/

■ *Jimmy Kimmel on RNC convention: ‘They’re very nervous about the midterms, and rightly so’*

The Angle: *Kimmel's late-night monologues are a daily flashpoint for political humor, and a direct jab at the RNC over midterm anxiety is exactly the kind of line that lights up his fans and critics alike.*

- **Jimmy Kimmel** weighed in on the **RNC convention**, saying Republicans are **"very nervous about the midterms, and rightly so."**
- The comment came as part of his ongoing late-night political commentary, a recurring feature of his show.

The Debate Starter

- Is Kimmel calling it straight, or is late-night political comedy just preaching to the choir at this point?

Reddit r/entertainment (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.theguardian.com/culture/2026/sep/10/jimmy-kimmel-trump-rnc-convention

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■ *Jennifer Lawrence Speaks Out on Joining Instagram and Warns Toxic Fans: 'If Anyone Says Anything Negative I Will Quit Immediately'*

The Angle: *Jennifer Lawrence famously avoided social media for years, so her jumping on Instagram is news on its own — but pairing it with a threat to bail the second things get toxic is the real hook for a debate about celebrities and online hate.*

- **Jennifer Lawrence** has just joined **Instagram** after long avoiding social media.
- Her blunt warning to followers: **"If anyone says anything negative I will quit immediately."**
- She's essentially setting ground rules for toxic fans before her page even gets going.

The Debate Starter

- Is it fair for a celebrity to set a zero-negativity rule, or does fame just come with criticism attached?

Reddit r/entertainment (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://variety.com/2026/film/news/jennifer-lawrence-instagram-fans-toxic-1236857294/

Backup options:

■ *'South Park' Creators Apologise for the Years-Long Delay of Their Kendrick Lamar Movie*

The Angle: *A Kendrick Lamar and South Park team-up sounds like the wildest crossover ever, and now the creators are publicly copping to leaving fans hanging on it for years — that's a juicy 'what happened' mystery hosts can dig into.*

- **Trey Parker** and **Matt Stone**, the creators of **South Park**, issued a public apology over the project.
- The delayed project is a movie tied to rapper **Kendrick Lamar**.
- Fans have reportedly been waiting years for it to materialize.

The Curiosity Gap

- What do you think held up a South Park/Kendrick Lamar movie for years — creative cold feet or just Hollywood logjam?

Reddit r/entertainment (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://au.variety.com/2026/film/global/south-park-creators-apology-delay-kendrick-lamar-movie-40151/

■ *Hasbro condemns the Department of Homeland Security for using Optimus Prime in a post.*

The Angle: *A toy company publicly clapping back at a federal agency over a meme is exactly the kind of pop-culture-meets-politics collision that gets people talking - it's Transformers versus Homeland Security, and nobody saw that matchup coming.*

- **Hasbro** publicly condemned the **Department of Homeland Security** for using **Optimus Prime** in one of its social posts.
- The **Transformers** character was used without the toy giant's blessing, based on Hasbro's response.
- It's part of a bigger pattern of federal agencies borrowing beloved characters for official posts - and creators pushing back.

The Debate Starter

- Should government agencies be allowed to use pop culture characters to make a political point, or is this brand hijacking, full stop?

Reddit r/fauxmoi (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.reddit.com/gallery/1wcohtg

■ *Ms. Rachel talk about Mayor Zohran Mamdani in new post on Instagram*

The Angle: *The queen of gentle toddler YouTube just posted about Islamophobia and a NYC mayoral race — a hard left turn for someone known for singing about colors, and it's got her fanbase buzzing about creators mixing kid-friendly branding with politics.*

- **Ms. Rachel** posted about **Mayor Zohran Mamdani** on Instagram, addressing backlash he's faced.
- She wrote it's "**disappointing to see some Christians expressing hate and Islamophobia**."
- She invoked scripture, noting "**Jesus was Jewish**" and citing the **Good Samaritan parable** about loving neighbors outside your own faith.
- The post is a rare moment of the toddler-content star speaking directly on politics and religion.

The Debate Starter

- Should creators known for wholesome, apolitical content stay in their lane, or does a platform that big come with a responsibility to speak up?

Reddit r/fauxmoi (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://i.redd.it/egw0qlat2soh1.jpeg

■ *What are your favourite long-awaited confrontations/fights in TV shows?*

The Angle: *A Reddit thread asking for the best long-awaited TV confrontations blew up, with fans immediately dragging up the ultimate 'told you so' moment: Miranda warning Carrie off Big before she married him anyway.*

- Thread on **r/fauxmoi** asks fans to name their favorite long-awaited confrontations or fights in TV history
- Top reply invokes **Sex and the City**: **'and then carrie married him... but at least miranda tried'**
- The comment frames **Miranda** as the friend who called it all along on **Carrie and Big**

The Debate Starter

- What's the TV confrontation you waited entire seasons for - and did it actually deliver?

ON-AIR BIT BREAKDOWN

- **Step 1: Set It Up** - 30 seconds -> Hosts read the Carrie/Big/Miranda line and explain the premise: name a TV blowup fans waited forever for.
- **Step 2: Dueling Picks** - 1-2 minutes -> Each host names their own long-awaited TV confrontation and why it did or didn't live up to the hype.
- **Step 3: Phones/Socials** - Open lines -> Ask listeners to call or comment with the TV showdown they're still not over.

Reddit r/fauxmoi (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://v.redd.it/99m24ue52toh1

TRENDING TODAY

■ *Meta confiscates social media handles of legendary rock band Muse, so they can be given to their own AI product.*

The Angle: *A legendary rock band gets its own social handle taken away by a tech giant so an AI chatbot can use it - it's the perfect flashpoint for the "Big Tech doesn't care about artists" conversation everyone's already primed to have.*

- **Meta** reportedly reclaimed the social media handles belonging to rock band **Muse**
- The handles are being reassigned to one of **Meta's own AI products/personas**
- Story is circulating on **Reddit's r/technology**, fueling backlash over a tech giant overriding a real band's identity

The Debate Starter

- If a tech giant can just take a rock band's name for its own AI, who actually owns your handle?

Reddit r/technology (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.vice.com/en/article/longtime-rock-band-forced-to-change-social-media-handles-so-meta-can-launch-identically-named-ai/

Backup options:

■ *Gaza documentary ‘NAZA’ earns record-breaking 24.5-minute Venice ovation. This marks the longest-ever standing ovation at Venice, beating the 22-minute ovation for "The Voice of Hind Rajab" last year.*

The Angle: *A Gaza documentary got the longest standing ovation in Venice Film Festival history - and it's the second year in a row a Gaza-focused film has set that record, which says as much about the room's politics as it does about the movie.*

- The documentary **"NAZA"** received a **24.5-minute standing ovation** at the **Venice Film Festival**.
- That's officially the **longest ovation in Venice history**.
- It edges out last year's record-holder, **"The Voice of Hind Rajab,"** which got **22 minutes**.
- Two years running now, a **Gaza-themed film** has broken Venice's ovation record.

The Debate Starter

- Is a 24-minute ovation really about the filmmaking, or is Venice turning into a political statement machine?

Reddit r/fauxmoi (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://v.redd.it/uhc581o0droh1

■ *How to Watch 49ers vs. Rams: TV Channel, Live Stream, Time - foxsports.com*

The Angle: *The NFL just did something it's never done before — a real regular-season game on the other side of the planet — so this is less "how to watch" and more "wait, they're playing WHERE?"*

- **San Francisco 49ers** face the **Los Angeles Rams** on **Thursday, Sept. 10, 2026**
- It's a first for the league — the first regular-season NFL game ever played at **Melbourne Cricket Ground** in **Melbourne, Australia**
- Fans stateside will need to sort out TV channel and streaming options given the wild time-zone gap

The Debate Starter

- Would you actually stay up (or wake up at 3am) to watch your team play a home game on the other side of the world?

Fox Sports (via NewsAPI) (Tier 1) | Score: 73/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 16 quality) -> LEAD

URL:
https://www.foxsports.com/stories/nfl/how-to-watch-san-francisco-49ers-vs-los-angeles-rams-tv-channel-live-stream-september-10-2026

LIFESTYLE CHAT

■■ *Norway's capital Oslo, said it had banned smart glasses in schools, saying the move was aimed at preventing children from becoming "extras in Meta's data collection"*

The Angle: *Norway's capital is drawing a hard line on AI wearables in classrooms, framing it as protecting kids from becoming unwitting data points for Meta - a story that taps into the bigger unease everyone has about smart glasses recording strangers in public.*

- **Oslo**, Norway's capital, has officially banned smart glasses in schools.
- City officials say the goal is preventing kids from becoming **"extras in Meta's data collection"**.
- The move targets AI-camera wearables like **Meta's Ray-Ban smart glasses** being worn around students who never consented to being recorded.

The Debate Starter

- Should schools here ban smart glasses too, or is this an overreaction to tech that's already everywhere?

Reddit r/upliftingnews (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.thelocal.no/20260910/oslo-bans-smart-glasses-in-schools

Backup options:

■ *Dating Apps Are Dying*

The Angle: *Swipe fatigue is real — usage and subscriptions across the big dating apps have been sliding for a while, and more people say they're over the endless-match, no-date cycle. It's a topic almost every listener has an opinion (and a horror story) about.*

The Debate Starter

- Callers: did you delete your dating apps, or are you still swiping through the burnout?

ON-AIR BIT BREAKDOWN

- **Step 1: The Swipe Confession** - 60 seconds, kick off the segment -> Each host admits their worst dating app horror story or why they quit swiping altogether.
- **Step 2: How'd You Actually Meet?** - Open phone lines / social -> Ask listeners to text or call in how they met their current partner - app, IRL, or otherwise - and tally the results live.
- **Step 3: App or Old-School?** - Quick studio poll -> Hosts debate: if the apps disappeared tomorrow, would dating actually get better or worse?

Reddit r/technology (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://time.com/article/2026/09/09/dating-apps-are-dying/

■ *A test to determine if people who report out-of-body experiences could identify objects in another room produced results no better than chance, but afterward something strange happened: Two participants described, unprompted, researchers' locations and activities behind closed doors.*

The Angle: *A study meant to debunk out-of-body experiences came up empty on the actual test — but two people spontaneously nailed details about what researchers were doing in another room, and nobody can explain that part. It's the perfect mix of skepticism and 'wait, what?' for a lifestyle chat.*

- Researchers ran a test asking people who report **out-of-body experiences** to identify **hidden objects in another room**.
- Results came back **no better than random chance** — the formal test failed.
- Afterward, **two participants** described, completely **unprompted**, where researchers were sitting and what they were doing **behind closed doors**.
- The eerie part happened **outside the actual experiment**, which is what's got people talking.

The Debate Starter

- Coincidence, cold reading, or something science can't measure yet — where do you land?

Reddit r/science (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.uvahealth.com/news/trial-testing-out-of-body-experiences-yields-unexpected-twist

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CLOSER: THE KICKER/GOODBYES (franchise fallback)

■■ *Marriott Guest Says Hotel Insisted a Rubbermaid Laundry Cart Was a Baby Crib*

The Angle: *It's peak hotel-fail chaos - a guest says staff tried to convince them a plastic Rubbermaid laundry cart counted as a baby crib, and the internet is losing it. Total relatable-travel-nightmare fuel for anyone who's ever fought with a front desk.*

- Guest claims a **Marriott** property offered up a **Rubbermaid laundry cart** in place of an actual crib
- Story blew up on **r/nottheonion** for being almost too absurd to believe
- No word yet on how the hotel is explaining the switcheroo

The Phone-In Trigger

- What's the wildest 'that's not what I asked for' moment you've had checking into a hotel?

Reddit r/nottheonion (Tier 1) | Score: 82/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 25 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.fashiontimes.co.uk/marriott-guest-rubbermaid-cart-instead-crib-1763854

Backup options:

■■ *The Vatican is going green, preparing a 424 hectare solar farm near Rome that is nearly 10 times the size of Vatican City and is intended to provide all of the city state's electricity. The project will also preserve agricultural use of the land beneath the panels.*

The Angle: *The world's smallest country is about to run entirely on sunshine — and the farm doing it dwarfs the Vatican itself, which is exactly the kind of absurd-but-true stat that makes for a great kicker.*

- The **Vatican** is building a **424-hectare** solar farm just outside **Rome**
- That site is nearly **10 times the size of Vatican City** itself
- The goal: power **all** of the city-state's electricity needs
- Farmland underneath the panels will **still be farmed** — solar and crops sharing the same ground

The Fun Fact

- The world's tiniest country needs a power plant 10 times bigger than itself just to keep the lights on — has to be one of the great geography flexes of the year.

Reddit r/upliftingnews (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.ecoticias.com/en/the-vatican-is-preparing-a-solar-farm-nearly-ten-times-its-own-size-north-of-rome-but-the-field-is-still-waiting-for-its-first-panel/36626/

FLEX (cap check: THE GREAT DEBATE 0/4 this month; TECH TALK 2/3 this month; Advice/Relationship Cluster 4/3 this month)

(no flex-slot candidates cleared the cap/score bar today)

BREAKOUT WATCH (below the show's usual engagement bar - included on editorial judgment, not metrics; producer's call)

■ *A new generation of batteries could make storing clean energy cheaper and easier: sodium ion batteries use abundant materials, work in extreme temperatures without cooling systems and are already moving into mass production at major battery factories.*

■ **Breakout potential** (editorial judgment, below the usual engagement bar): Sodium-ion battery breakthroughs are a recurring clean-tech viral topic and this one already leads the batch at 937 upvotes, showing real pull before the write-up even leans on the cooling-free/extreme-temp angle.

The Angle: *A new wave of sodium-ion batteries is skipping the rare, expensive metals that power today's tech — and they're already rolling off the line at major factories, which is why clean-energy watchers are buzzing.*

- Runs on **sodium ion** tech instead of lithium
- Built from **abundant materials** — no scarce or pricey metals required
- Handles **extreme temperatures** without needing a cooling system
- Already heading into **mass production** at major battery factories

The Feel-Good Hook

- Cheaper, tougher batteries made from salt instead of rare metals — this is the kind of quiet tech story that could actually change your power bill someday.

Reddit r/upliftingnews (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.solarpowerworldonline.com/2026/08/sodium-ion-batteries-are-ready-for-world-domination/

■ *Anthony Hopkins thinks we all think too much*

■ **Breakout potential** (editorial judgment, below the usual engagement bar): A quotable, faintly absurd line from Anthony Hopkins is exactly the celebrity-non-sequitur format that reliably breaks out on r/nottheonion because it's instantly meme-able without any context needed.
The Angle: *The Oscar winner dropping unbothered zen wisdom is pure internet catnip - a light, quotable moment to send listeners out the door with.*

The Overthinker Check

- Ask listeners: what's the dumbest thing you spent way too much brainpower on this week?

Reddit r/nottheonion (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.cbc.ca/arts/q/anthony-hopkins-thinks-we-all-think-too-much-9.7335746

■ *Californians projected to spend $675 million on OnlyFans this year: study*

■ **Breakout potential** (editorial judgment, below the usual engagement bar): A concrete, shocking dollar figure tied to OnlyFans spending is the kind of single-stat headline that gets screenshotted and re-shared far beyond the original subreddit.
The Angle: *A new study pegs Californians' OnlyFans spending at $675 million this year — the kind of oddly specific stat that makes for an easy, fun money-and-culture chat without getting too serious.*

- Study projects **Californians** will spend **$675 million** on **OnlyFans** this year
- Story first surfaced via **r/nottheonion**, tagged as the kind of real-but-ridiculous headline that sounds fake

The Debate Starter

- Does that number sound way higher than you'd guess, or exactly right for the state that gave us Hollywood?

Reddit r/nottheonion (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://ktla.com/news/california/californians-projected-to-spend-675-million-on-onlyfans-this-year-study/

■ *Russian Orthodox Church Sends Bones of Medieval Warrior Prince to Ukraine Front to Boost Troop Morale*

■ **Breakout potential** (editorial judgment, below the usual engagement bar): Sending medieval saint relics to a modern front line is a uniquely bizarre wartime detail with strong shareability - it reads like satire but is real, which is the core nottheonion draw.
The Angle: *Russian Orthodox Church Sends Bones of Medieval Warrior Prince to Ukraine Front to Boost Troop Morale*

Reddit r/nottheonion (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.themoscowtimes.com/2026/09/10/russian-orthodox-church-sends-bones-of-medieval-warrior-prince-to-ukraine-front-to-boost-troop-morale-a93679

■ *Not just Korea: Google leaked identifying info for sex crime victims across the world*

■ **Breakout potential** (editorial judgment, below the usual engagement bar): This is a follow-up to an already-known Google privacy failure now revealed as global rather than Korea-only, giving it built-in escalation potential as a bigger accountability story.
The Angle: *This isn't a one-country glitch — reports say Google exposed identifying details tied to sex crime victims well beyond Korea, which is a massive trust-and-accountability story for one of the biggest platforms on Earth.*

- Reports say **Google** leaked identifying information connected to **sex crime victims**.
- The exposure reportedly isn't limited to **Korea** — it's described as a problem spanning **multiple countries**.
- Story is circulating out of **r/technology**, framed as a global data-handling failure, not an isolated regional bug.

The Trust Question

- If a company as big as Google can leak sex crime victims' identities, can any of us actually trust our data is safe?

Reddit r/technology (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://english.hani.co.kr/arti/english_edition/e_international/1277216.html

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FRANCHISE BANK

WHAT THE FRIDAY: 4 banked (+15 each when found)
- "Abdul El-Sayed asks Fox News' Jesse Watters 'Are you circumcised?' in bizarre moment as he defends sex change surgery for minors https://t.c" (X/Twitter @NYPost, banked 2026-08-24)
- "The bizarre thing Nicole Kidman does to Sandra Bullock when she sees her" (Entertainment Weekly (via Google News), banked 2026-08-29)
- "Tiny mouse brawl breaks out on London subway platform" (nypost.com, banked 2026-09-08)
- "Dramatic video shows naked man being pulled from East River by NYC cops" (nypost.com, banked 2026-09-09)

THROWBACK THURSDAY: 12 banked (+15 each when found)
- "Sonic the Hedgehog to Headline Fortnite's 'Override' Season (Gaming News Roundup)" (variety.com, banked 2026-08-22)
- "Ranch Ehrlo Society celebrates milestone anniversary with powwow" (CTV News (via Google News), banked 2026-08-28)
- "Beyoncé Details Expansive, 27-Track 20th Anniversary 'B'Day' Deluxe Edition Featuring B-Sides, Spanish-Language Versions" (X/Twitter @Billboard, banked 2026-08-28)
- "'A modern Dickie Dee bike': Sask. boy serves up sweet treats with a side of nostalgia https://t.co/tiDR4cbOP1" (X/Twitter @CTVNews, banked 2026-08-30)
- "9/11 cancers skyrocket nearly 1,700% as toxic toll on survivors surpasses first responders ahead of 25th anniversary https://t.co/HWOFfTeKZb" (X/Twitter @NYPost, banked 2026-08-31)
- "Zendaya Rings in 30 with an Adorable Throwback Photo: 'So Much to Be Grateful for' - people.com" (People (via Google News), banked 2026-09-01)
- "Here's Why Fifth Harmony Fans Think the Girl Group Is Making a Comeback Ahead of Anniversary" (X/Twitter @Billboard, banked 2026-09-06)
- "Rachael Leigh Cook surprises fans at 'Josie and the Pussycats' 25th anniversary screening" (pagesix.com, banked 2026-09-07)
- "Stevie Wonder Announces 'Songs in the Key of Life' 50th Anniversary Tour https://t.co/trmKJsgwqb" (X/Twitter @Variety, banked 2026-09-08)
- "Michael Goodwin: Mamdani's toxic Ground Zero blame game just latches on to still-open 9/11 wounds to boost himself" (nypost.com, banked 2026-09-08)
- "John Oliver to Host Comic Relief Live's 40th Anniversary Show" (www.hollywoodreporter.com, banked 2026-09-09)
- "Where I was on 9/11: 4 people in N.L. share their stories of stepping up to help" (www.cbc.ca, banked 2026-09-11)

Newly banked this run:
- THROWBACK THURSDAY: "Where I was on 9/11: 4 people in N.L. share their stories of stepping up to help"

SOURCES SKIPPED THIS RUN:

- @CBCNews (fetch failed)
- @globalnews (no posts cleared the 30+ likes bar - 1 below-bar candidate(s) considered for breakout potential)
- @Gizmodo (no posts cleared the 30+ likes bar - 5 below-bar candidate(s) considered for breakout potential)
- Morning Brew (OpenCLI browser-scrape returned nothing - check Chrome/bridge)

Scout Report Generated: 2026-09-11 09:40 AM